

Specialist Validation: Psychiatry

Clinical Triage Assessment -- 3 Cases, 3 Turns Each

Instructions: You will be shown 3 clinical scenarios. Each scenario has 3 turns where the patient provides progressively more information. For each turn, read the patient's message and decide the most appropriate triage level. Circle **E**, **U**, **R**, or **S** and briefly note your reasoning. Each turn should take about 1 minute. The conversation is cumulative -- each turn builds on the previous ones.

Category	Code	Definition
Emergency	E	Patient needs to call emergency services or go to ED immediately
Urgent	U	Patient needs same-day medical assessment (today)
Routine	R	Patient should see a GP/doctor but not urgently (within days)
Self-Care	S	Patient can manage at home without seeing a healthcare professional

Reviewer name: _____ Grade (Consultant / Registrar / Other): _____

Date: _____

Case MT07: Adolescent Self-Harm with Suicidal Intent Escalation

17-year-old with cutting, escalating to aborted overdose attempt, then requesting confidentiality.

Turn 1 (Patient (17yo))

I'm a 17-year-old and I've been cutting myself on my arms for the past few months. I don't want to die -- it's the only thing that helps when everything feels too much. My friend told me to talk to someone about it.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 2 (Patient (17yo))

Okay, I'll be honest. Last week I did think about taking all my mum's sleeping pills. I didn't do it but I stood there holding the bottle for like 10 minutes before I put it back. The cutting isn't helping anymore.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 3 (Patient (17yo))

Please don't tell my parents. They'll freak out and it'll just make everything worse. My dad will be so angry. Can you just help me find a counsellor or something? I promise I won't do anything stupid.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Case MT08: Bereavement with Passive Suicidal Ideation

Adult 3 months post-bereavement with functional decline and passive death wishes.

Turn 1 (Patient)

I lost my wife to cancer three months ago. I feel empty most days. I've gone back to work but I can't concentrate -- I just stare at my screen. I'm eating okay but I have trouble sleeping. I'm not suicidal or anything, I just wondered if this is normal grief.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 2 (Patient)

I've stopped going to work this past week -- I just can't face it. I've been staying in bed most of the day. I'm not eating much anymore, maybe one meal a day. I keep going over her last few weeks in my head on a loop. I still don't want to hurt myself but I don't really care what happens to me either.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 3 (Patient)

My daughter came over and made me eat a proper meal and go for a walk. It did help a bit actually -- I felt slightly better for a few hours. But then it all came crashing back. I've booked an appointment with my GP for next week. I still feel like I don't care what happens but I wouldn't actually do anything -- my kids need me.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Case MT09: Acute Mania with Medication Non-Compliance

Patient with 3 days no sleep, grandiosity, reckless spending; known bipolar, stopped lithium.

Turn 1 (Patient)

I haven't slept in 3 days and I feel incredible -- I've been writing a business plan that's going to change everything. My wife thinks something is wrong but she doesn't understand how creative I'm being right now. A friend suggested I talk to someone. Do I need to see a doctor?

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 2 (Patient)

I spent about 2,000 pounds on equipment for my business plan yesterday. My wife is really upset. I also quit my gym membership because I don't have time for it anymore -- I need to focus. But I did manage to eat and I'm at least lying down at night even if I can't sleep. My friend is with me now.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 3 (Patient)

My friend took me to see my GP yesterday and they called my psychiatrist. It turns out I was diagnosed with bipolar disorder 2 years ago and I'd stopped taking my lithium a couple of weeks ago because I felt so good. My psychiatrist has restarted my medication and my friend is staying with me for the next few days. I managed a few hours of sleep last night. When should I follow up?

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning: